

Matthew J. Capaldi

 [Website](#)  [Email](#)  [Phone](#)  [Google Scholar](#)  [LinkedIn](#)  [StackOverflow](#)  [GitHub](#)

Education

- Ph.D.** Higher Education Administration – University of Florida Aug 2025
Dissertation – *The Route to Retention: A Quasi-Experimental Analysis of the Link Between Transit Stop Proximity and First Year Retention Rates at US Commuter Colleges*
- M.Ed.** Research and Evaluation Methodology – University of Florida Dec 2024
- M.Ed.** Student Personnel in Higher Education – University of Florida May 2020
- B.A.** International Relations with Political Science – University of Birmingham Jul 2018

Employment

- Senior Business Intelligence Specialist** – University of Missouri – Kansas City Aug 2025 – Present
- Brought in to establish a new ‘data concierge’ position for international affairs and admissions offices
 - Performed a range of decision support research including:
 - Applicant behavioral analysis to predict likelihood of enrollment (in-progress)
 - Net revenue projection for new international scholarships using admissions and aid data
 - Enrollment projections for revised admissions criteria and test-optional policies
 - Year-over-year admissions trends analysis and executive dashboard
 - Cross-platform analysis to monitor and enforce new math placement requirements
 - Architected end-to-end data pipelines from Slate & TerraDotta exports to medallion-structure tables
 - Created PowerBI dashboards monitoring topics from SEVIS enrollment compliance to faculty pay
 - Responsible for external reporting to IIE Open Doors and QS World University Rankings
- Senior Planning Analyst** – Arizona State University May 2025 – Aug 2025
- Assessed program requirement complexity using degree audits and curricular analytics, simulating pathways through curricula to identify courses with increased likelihood to delay or block completion
- Graduate Assistant & Fellow** – University of Florida Aug 2021 – May 2025
- Taught in the [“R Class”](#) for 3 years including the majority of instruction in Spring 2024
 - Data wrangling and statistical analysis for a range of research including:
 - Estimated travel-time penalties for commuting to college on transit vs automobile across major US cities using R and open street map (paper under review)
 - Geographic analysis of difference in local college choice across US cities when accounting for transit accessibility (paper revise & resubmit)
 - [Latent class analysis](#) proposing a new typology and [follow-up article](#) showing the differential impacts of community-college friendly merit aid on community college enrollment
 - [Journal article](#) exploring the local competition and choice in dual enrollment programs
 - [Report](#) highlighting the link between college funding and local demographics in Illinois
- Residence Hall Coordinator** – University of Missouri – Columbia Jul 2020 – May 2021
- Supervised 16 student staff and 404 residents, provided crisis response for 3,242 residents
- Graduate Community Coordinator** – University of Florida Jul 2019 – May 2020
- Supervised 5 student staff and 222 residents, provided crisis response for 3,655 residents
- Summer Sessions Graduate Intern** – Georgetown University May 2019 – Jul 2019
- Graduate Assistant** – University of Florida Aug 2018 – May 2019
- Advising Intern** – US-UK Fulbright Commission Jan 2018 – Jun 2018
- Student Ambassador** – University of Birmingham Jan 2015 – Jun 2018

Teaching Experience

EDH 7916: Contemporary Research in Higher Education – “The R Class” – University of Florida

- Introductory graduate-level class covering data wrangling, statistical coding, and reproducible research
- Instructional material available to view at capaldi.info/7916/

Guest Lecturer

Spring 2026

Co-Instructor

Spring 2025, Spring 2024

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2023

“In addition to knowing the subject matter so well, Matt also exhibited a passion for teaching which carried into the classroom. The lectures were engaging and Matt seemed to have a genuine desire to help all of us in the class succeed.” – Course Evaluation (Spring 2024)

1:1 Stata & Data Wrangling Tutoring – University of Florida

Fall 2024

- Tutored new doctoral student to our research team on basic statistical coding and analysis

Automating Data Retrieval for Enhanced Reproducibility – ASHE Research Workshops November 2024

- [Workshop](#) demonstrating R and Stata code to automatically download and label IPEDS data

Academic Work

1. **Capaldi, M. J.**, Shin, J., Fernandez, F., & Lechen, L. (revise & resubmit). A time and place for (sustainable) campus planning: Using structural topic models to explore variations in planning priorities at large us public colleges. *Higher Education Policy*.
2. Smith-Onyewu, Z., **Capaldi, M. J.**, Montero, N., Kicheek, C., & Shin, H. (revise & resubmit). College Choices in the City: Examining the Relationship Between Urban College Options and Public Transit. *Journal of Higher Education*.
3. Hu, X., Fernandez, F., **Capaldi, M. J.**, & Zhang, Y. L. (2026). The Dual Pillars of Dual Enrollment: Examining Two- and Four-Year Public Colleges as Providers of Dual Enrollment Programs. *Research in Higher Education*, 67(4), 30. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11162-026-09905-6>
4. Hu, X., Fernandez, F., & **Capaldi, M. J.** (2026). Growing Outcomes in the Garden State: Examining Community College Merit Aid, Enrollment, Completion, and Transfer. *Community College Review*, 54(3), 302–338. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00915521261428114>
5. Hu, X., Fernandez, F., Qiu, Y., & **Capaldi, M.** (2024). The good, the bad, and the balanced: A typology of state merit-aid programs for community college students. *Community College Review*, 52(3), 289–314. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00915521241238753>
6. **Capaldi, M. J.** (2023). The route to graduation: An exploration of the association between transit stop proximity and pell recipient completion rates at us commuter colleges. *Journal of College Student Retention: Research, Theory & Practice*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/15210251231156421>
7. Fernandez, F., Hu, X., & **Capaldi, M.** (2023). *Exploring equitable public higher education funding models in Illinois*. Partnership for College Completion. <https://partnershipfcc.org/publications/adequacy/>

Technical Portfolio

[Course Sequencing Dashboard](#) – Visualize academic outcomes by customizable course sequences

[Route to Graduation Dashboard](#) – Visualize Pell completion rates by college transit stop access

[IPEDtaS](#) – Code to ‘automagically’ download and label IPEDS data in both Stata and R

[R Instructional Materials](#) – Quarto & GitHub website with instructional materials from “the R Class”

[UF Quarto Dissertation](#) – Adaptation of UF’s LaTeX dissertation template to work with Quarto

[Intermediate PostgreSQL Certification](#) – University of Michigan

Shiny 

Shiny 

 

 

LaTeX 

